

LACHS VULNERABLE ELDER'S SURVEY (VES-13)

Identification of Older Persons at Risk of Functional Decline or Death

1. PATIENT IDENTIFICATION

Patient Name: _____

Age / DOB: ____/____/____

MRN / ID: _____

Unit / Ward / Bed: _____

Surgery / Diagnosis: _____

Date / Time: ____/____/____ : ____

1. AGE & HEALTH

Parameter / Criterion	Options & Points
1. Age Score	☐ < 75 years (0) (0) ☐ 75 - 84 years (1) (1) ☐ ≥ 85 years (3) (3)
2. Self-Rated Health	☐ Good / Excellent (0) (0) ☐ Fair / Poor (1) (1)

Clinical Scoring Rule: Sum points from Age (0-3), Self-Rated Health (0-1), Physical Limitations (max 2 pts), and IADLs (max 4 pts). Total score ranges from 0 to 10. A score of 3 or higher identifies vulnerable elders requiring comprehensive geriatric care.

2. FUNCTIONAL LIMITATIONS

Parameter / Criterion	Options & Points
3. Stooping, crouching	☐ No difficulty (0) (0) ☐ Some/Much difficulty (1) (1)
4. Lifting 10 lbs	☐ No difficulty (0) (0) ☐ Some/Much difficulty (1) (1)
5. Reaching above shoulders	☐ No difficulty (0) (0) ☐ Some/Much difficulty (1) (1)
6. Writing, small objects	☐ No difficulty (0) (0) ☐ Some/Much difficulty (1) (1)
7. Walking 1/4 mile	☐ No difficulty (0) (0) ☐ Some/Much difficulty (1) (1)
8. Heavy housework	☐ No difficulty (0) (0) ☐ Some/Much difficulty (1) (1)
9. Shopping groceries	☐ No difficulty (0) (0) ☐ Needs help / Unable (1) (1)
10. Managing money	☐ No difficulty (0) (0) ☐ Needs help / Unable (1) (1)
11. Walking across room	☐ No difficulty (0) (0) ☐ Needs help / Unable (1) (1)

TOTAL SCORE: [] POINTS (Maximum: 10 points (Risk if ≥ **Assessor (RN / License #):** 3))

CLINICAL INTERPRETATION & RECOMMENDED NURSING ACTIONS

Robust / Non-Vulnerable (0 - 2 points)

Low risk of death or functional deterioration in 2 years. Preventive care.

Vulnerable Elder (≥ 3 points)

4.2x higher risk of functional decline or mortality. Comprehensive Geriatric Assessment (CGA) indicated.

Registered Nurse (RN) Signature & Professional Stamp

Date & Time of Assessment